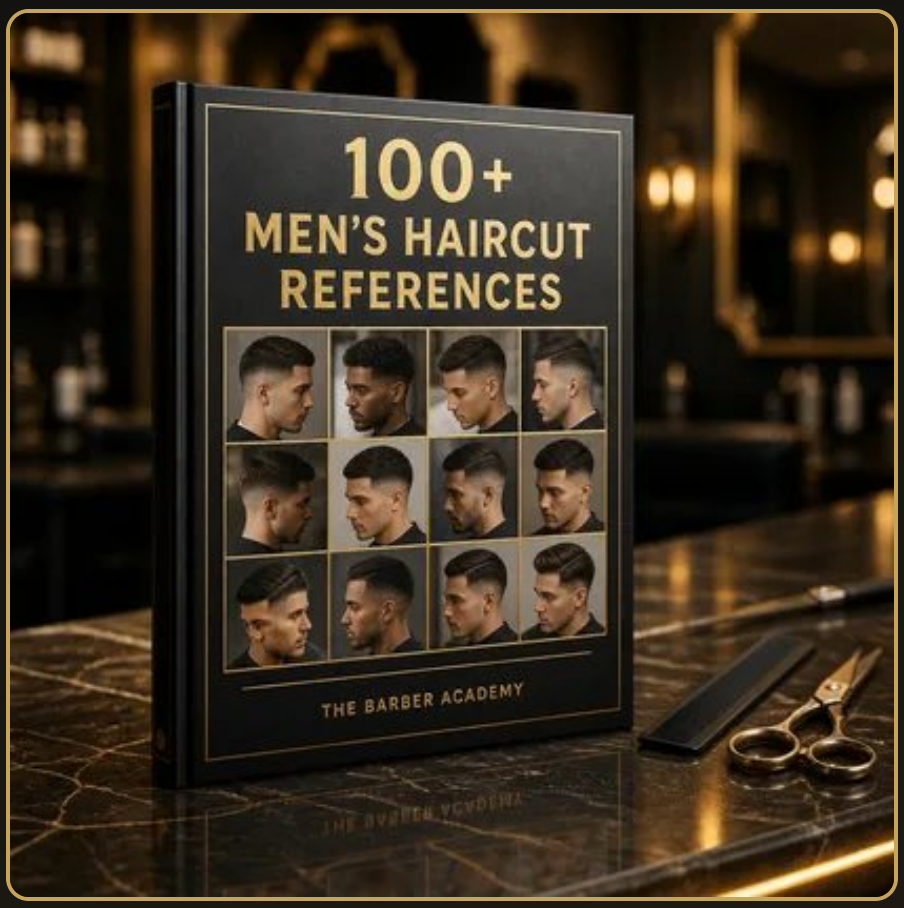
BONUS 2

100+ Men's Haircut References

108 styles with guards, steps and what to ask for



In this guide

- How to Use This Reference
- How to Read a Style Card
- Guard Number Table
- Face Shape and Hair Type Guide
- Running a Consultation with the Reference
- Fades
- Tapers
- Classic cuts
- Crops and textures
- Long and medium
- Curly and wavy
- Buzz and short
- Flat tops and high tops
- Beard-friendly and combos
- Designs and parts
- Next step

This reference gives you 108 men's haircut styles, each on a single card: what it is, who it tends to suit, which guards to use, how to build it step by step, and what to say to the barber.

About the illustrations

The front and side drawings are schematic guides to the shape and fade level, not photographs. Use them to plan, then check the real head and hair.

How to Use This Reference

Use it three ways: to **plan** a cut before the client sits down, to **talk** through options during a consultation, and to **practice** one style at a time on a mannequin head or under supervision. Start with the Beginner cards, then move up.

How to Read a Style Card

- **Category and level:** where the style sits and how demanding it is (Beginner, Intermediate, Advanced).
- **Guards:** suggested guard numbers and scissor lengths, a starting point and not a rule.
- **Steps:** the order of work, from prep to finish.
- **Ask for:** a sentence the client can say to the barber.
- **Maintenance and styling:** how often to return and how to style at home.
- **Avoid:** who it may not suit.

Guard Number Table

Guard numbers count in 1/8 in steps: #1 = 1/8 in, #2 = 1/4 in, and so on. Sets differ slightly, so test on a small area first.

GUARD	LENGTH (IN)	LENGTH (MM)	TYPICAL USE
#0.5	1/16	about 1.5	Closest fade layer
#1	1/8	about 3	Fade base, short buzz
#2	1/4	about 6	Fade mid, buzz
#3	3/8	about 10	Taper, buzz
#4	1/2	about 13	Taper top, short sides
#5	5/8	about 16	Short crop
#6	3/4	about 19	Longer buzz top
#7	7/8	about 22	Top blend

GUARD	LENGTH (IN)	LENGTH (MM)	TYPICAL USE
#8	1	about 25	Longest standard guard

Face Shape and Hair Type Guide

These are starting points for the conversation, not rules. The client's preferences, hairline, growth patterns and lifestyle matter more.

FACE SHAPE	WHAT TENDS TO WORK	OFTEN AVOIDED
Oval	Almost any style	Heavy fringes that hide the face
Round	Height on top, tight sides, angles	Wide, full sides
Square	Soft textures, medium sides	Very blocky shapes
Oblong	Fringes, volume at the sides	Extra height on top
Heart	Fringes, medium length, fuller sides	Very short tops with tight sides

HAIR TYPE	WHAT TENDS TO WORK	NOTES
Straight	Crops, slick backs, quiffs	Shows every line, so be exact
Wavy	Textured tops, medium flows	Shrinks as it dries; leave a little length
Curly	Curl-friendly tops, fades	Cut with the curl pattern, never stretched
Coily	Tapers, high tops, shape-ups	Allow for shrinkage; moisturize

Running a Consultation with the Reference

1. Ask what the client likes and dislikes about the current cut.
2. Look at hair type, density, cowlicks, hairline and face shape.
3. Show two or three cards and discuss the guards and length.
4. Confirm the length in inches or guard numbers, not just words like short.
5. Explain upkeep and styling time, then agree on the plan before starting.

CONSULTATION CHECKLIST

☐ Hair type and density checked

☐ Hairline and cowlicks noted

☐ Length agreed in numbers

☐ Upkeep and styling discussed

☐ Skin or scalp issues noted

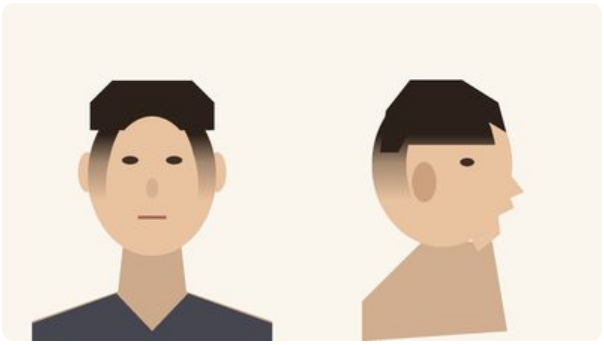
Safety and Licensing

Always sanitize tools, use clean capes, and use a new single-use blade for every razor service. Check your local licensing requirements: many places require a barber or cosmetology license to cut hair for clients. A certificate of completion is not a license.

No Promises

This is a reference, not a guarantee. Results depend on hair, tools, practice and skill, and nothing here promises a particular outcome, job, or income.

Fades



1. Low Skin Fade with Textured Crop

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | heart

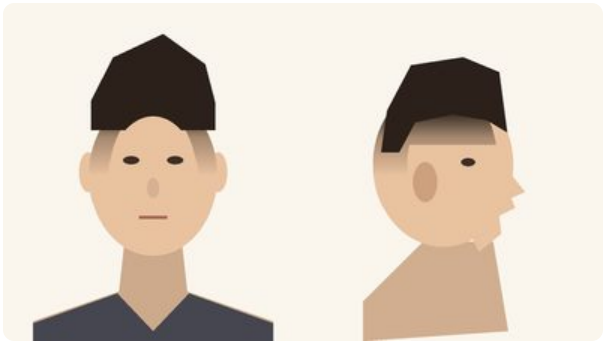
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended; top: scissor 1.5 to 2.5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
5. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Low skin fade, blended up to a #2, with a textured crop on top and a short fringe.*

Styling: Work a pea-sized amount of matte clay through dry hair with fingertips and push the fringe forward.

May not suit: Very fine, thinning hair may look sparse with a heavy texture.



2. Mid Skin Fade with Quiff

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

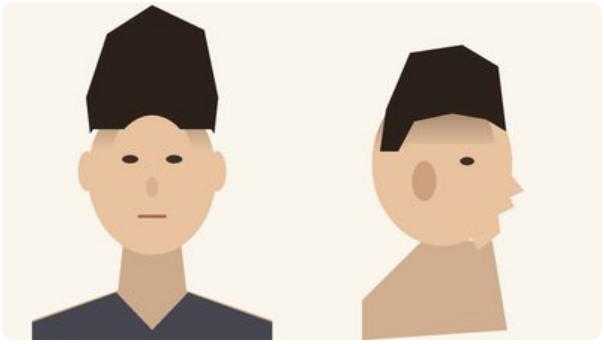
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #3 blended; top: scissor 3 to 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Leave extra length at the front and cut the top with scissors over comb.
5. Texturize the front with point cutting so it lifts and sweeps up and back.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Mid skin fade with a quiff on top, longer at the front.*

Styling: Blow-dry up and back, then set with a light-hold paste.

May not suit: Strong cowlicks at the front hairline can fight the lift.



3. High Skin Fade with Pompadour

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square

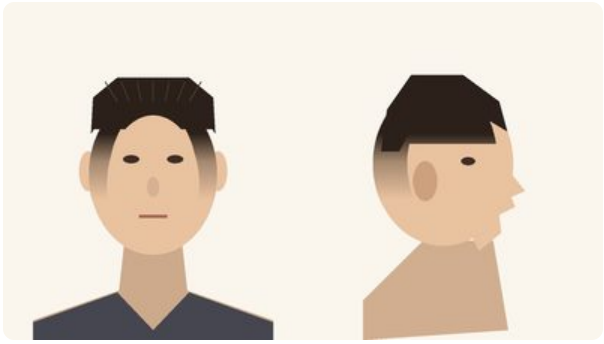
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended high; top: scissor 4 to 5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a high fade line near the top of the head, around the temple.
3. Blend with light flicks and a mid-length guard so the high line melts into the top.
4. Keep generous length at the front and cut it with a rising line toward the crown.
5. Connect the top to the sides with a blending pass so the shape flows.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *High skin fade with a classic pompadour and a smooth blend.*

Styling: Blow-dry with a round brush, then style with a medium-shine pomade.

May not suit: A very long face can look longer with extra height.



4. Low Drop Fade with Slick Back

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

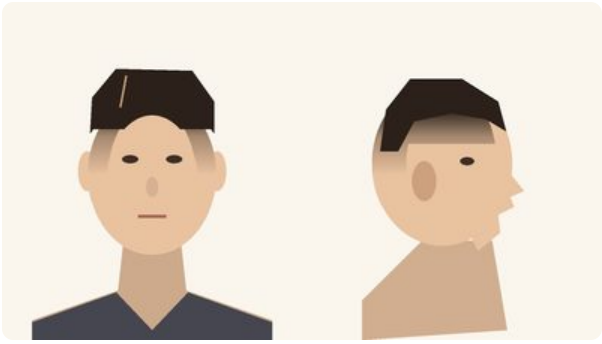
Guards and lengths: Sides: #0.5 to #2 blended along a curved line; top: scissor 3 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Comb the top straight back and cut to an even length with scissors over comb.
5. Blend the top into the sides so it lies smoothly without bumps.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Low drop fade curving behind the ear, with the top slicked back.*

Styling: Apply a water-based pomade on damp hair and comb straight back.

May not suit: Receding hairlines may be more visible when slicked back.



5. Bald Fade with Comb Over

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round

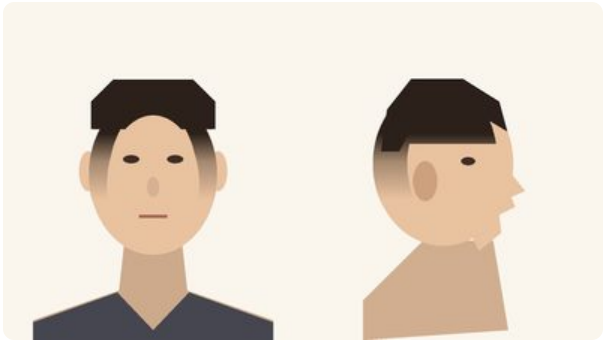
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin (bald) to #1 blended; top: scissor 2 to 3 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Cut a clear side part, then trim the top with scissors over comb to a shallow slope.
5. Check that the hair lies flat across the part when combed.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Bald fade with a clean hard part and a short comb over.*

Styling: Use a light cream or pomade and comb the part into place on damp hair.

May not suit: Fine, flat hair may collapse; add a light sea salt spray if needed.



6. Low Taper Fade with Messy Fringe

Beginner | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | heart | square

Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 blended low; top: scissor 1 to 2 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Cut the top short with texture and a straight fringe cut across the forehead.
4. Point-cut the fringe so it looks natural and not blunt.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Low fade, a bit of length on top, and a messy fringe.*

Styling: Rub a small amount of texture cream through towel-dried hair and finger-comb forward.

May not suit: Heavy cowlicks may make the fringe lie unevenly.



7. Mid Burst Fade with Curls

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | curly | coily | oval | square | round | heart

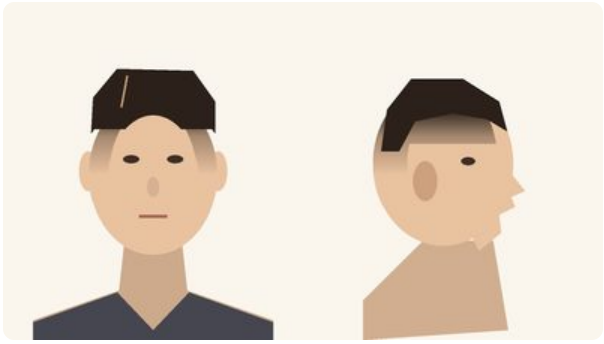
Guards and lengths: Burst fade: skin to #2 around the ear only; top: scissor 2 to 3 in curls

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
5. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Mid burst fade around the ear with my natural curls kept on top.*

Styling: Apply a curl cream on damp hair and diffuse or air dry.

May not suit: Very tight, short curls may need a longer top to show the shape.



8. Skin Fade with Hard Part

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

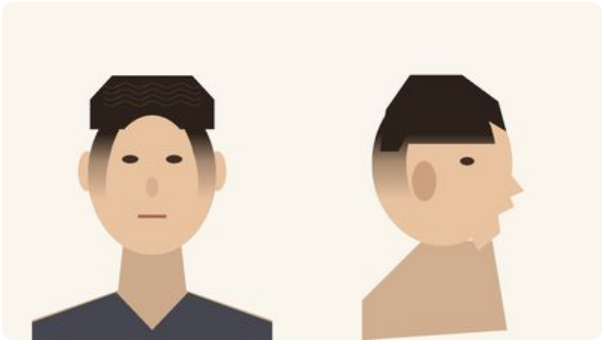
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended; top: scissor 2 to 3 in, razored part line

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Skin fade with a hard part cut into the side.*

Styling: Smooth a pomade through the top and comb away from the part.

May not suit: A very round face may benefit from adding height first.



9. Low Fade with Wavy Top

Beginner | Every 3 weeks | wavy | curly | oval | square | heart

Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 blended low; top: scissor 3 to 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Cut the top with the hair relaxed and natural, working with the wave direction.
4. Keep length even enough that waves can stack without gaps.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Low fade with the wavy hair on top left natural and tidy.*

Styling: Apply a light mousse or cream to damp hair and let it dry naturally.

May not suit: Straight, fine hair will not hold waves without styling.



10. High Fade Spiky Top

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

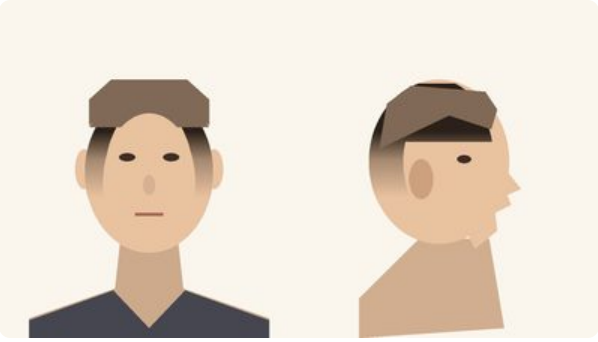
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended high; top: scissor 1.5 to 2 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a high fade line near the top of the head, around the temple.
3. Blend with light flicks and a mid-length guard so the high line melts into the top.
4. Cut the top short and uneven with point cutting for separation.
5. Shorten the tips at varying lengths so the hair stands up in distinct pieces.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *High fade with a short, spiky textured top.*

Styling: Use a firm-hold clay and push the hair up with fingers.

May not suit: Very thin hair may look sparse when spiked.



11. Zero Fade with Shape-Up

Beginner | Every 1-2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square | oblong

Guards and lengths: Sides: zero (no guard) to #1 blended; top: #3 to #4 guard

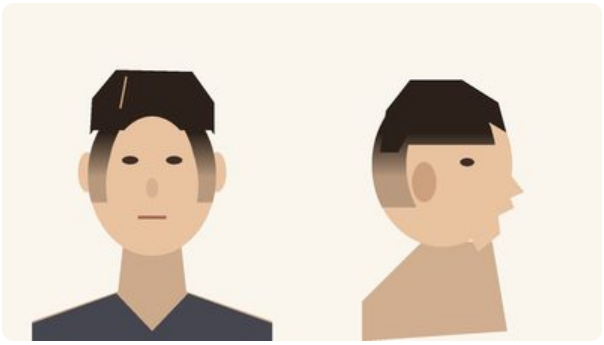
1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
4. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A zero fade with a crisp line-up and a short top.*

Styling: Skip product; use a light scalp moisturizer.

May not suit: Needs frequent upkeep to stay sharp.

Tapers



12. Classic Scissor Taper

Beginner | Every 3-4 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round | oblong | heart

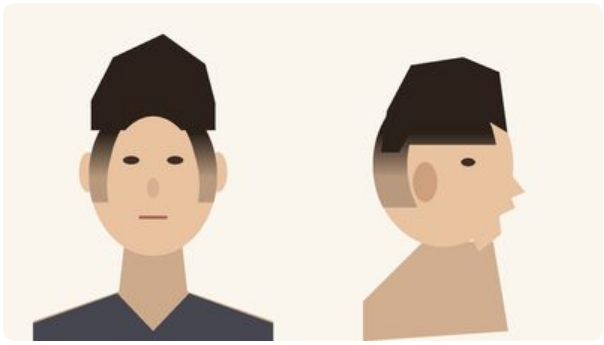
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #4 tapered; top: scissor 2.5 to 3.5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
4. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A classic taper on the sides and neckline with a natural side part.*

Styling: Use a small amount of cream or light pomade on damp hair.

May not suit: Very little; works with nearly any cut and face.



13. Taper Fade with Long Top

Intermediate | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

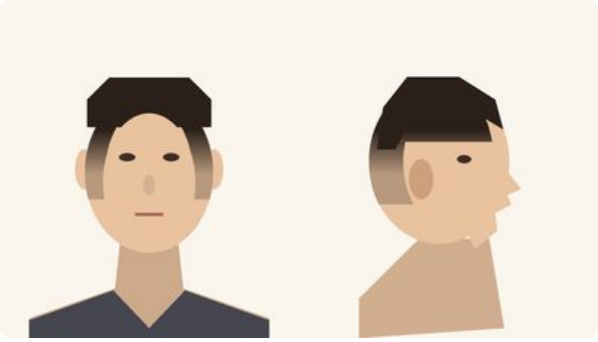
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 3 to 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Leave extra length at the front and cut the top with scissors over comb.
5. Texturize the front with point cutting so it lifts and sweeps up and back.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Taper fade, keeping the length on top for a quiff.*

Styling: Blow-dry up, then style with a matte paste.

May not suit: Fine hair may flop; use a volumizing spray.



14. Temple Taper with Textured Top

Beginner | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | heart

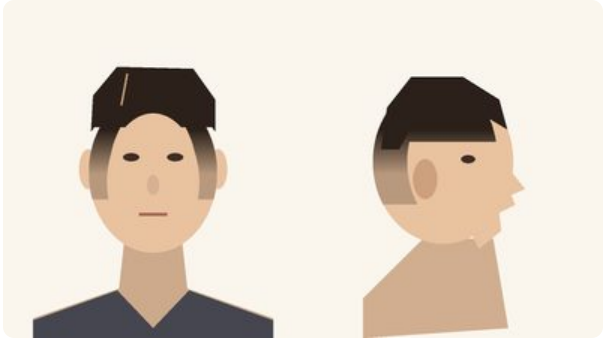
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1.5 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 1.5 to 2.5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
4. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Taper at the temples and neckline with a textured top.*

Styling: Apply a pinch of matte clay and tousle.

May not suit: Heavy cowlicks may need an adjustment.



15. Neckline Taper with Short Back and Sides

Beginner | Every 4 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | oval | round | square | oblong | heart

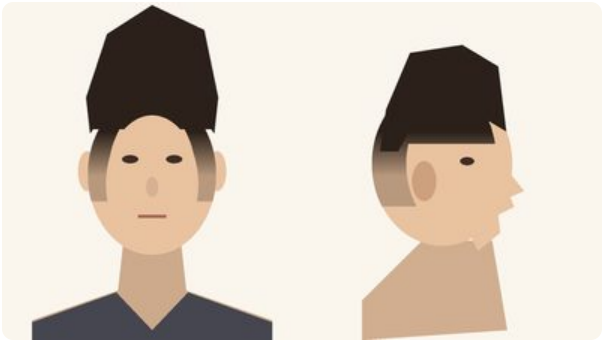
Guards and lengths: Sides and back: #2 to #4 tapered; top: scissor 2 to 3 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
4. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Short back and sides with a natural neckline taper.*

Styling: Use a light pomade to hold the part.

May not suit: Thick necks may want a tapered rather than blocked neckline.



16. Tapered Pompadour

Advanced | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square

Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #4 tapered; top: scissor 4 to 5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Keep generous length at the front and cut it with a rising line toward the crown.
5. Connect the top to the sides with a blending pass so the shape flows.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *Tapered sides with a full pompadour.*

Styling: Blow-dry up with a brush and lock in with pomade.

May not suit: Needs enough density up front.



17. Natural Taper with Curls

Beginner | Every 3-4 weeks | curly | coily | oval | square | round | heart

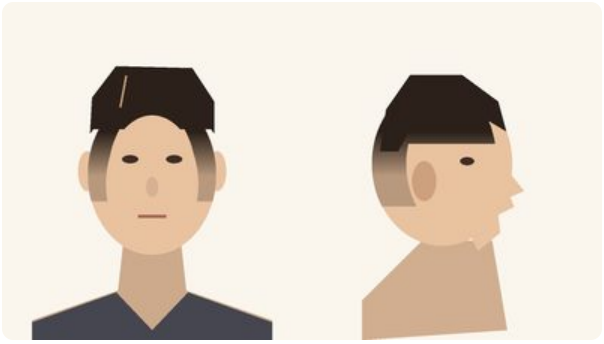
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 3 to 4 in curls

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
4. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A natural taper that keeps the length on top for my curls.*

Styling: Apply curl cream on damp hair and define with fingers.

May not suit: None in particular; adapt top length to curl tightness.



18. Taper with Side Swept Fringe

Intermediate | Every 3-4 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | heart | oblong

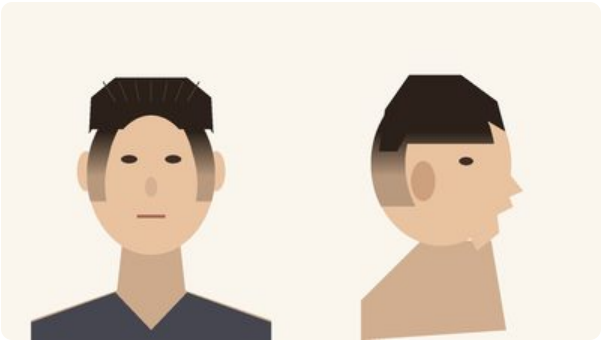
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #4 tapered; top: scissor 3 to 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Taper on the sides with a side-swept fringe on top.*

Styling: Use light cream and comb the fringe to the side.

May not suit: Round faces may prefer extra height at the crown.



19. Low Taper with Comb Back

Beginner | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

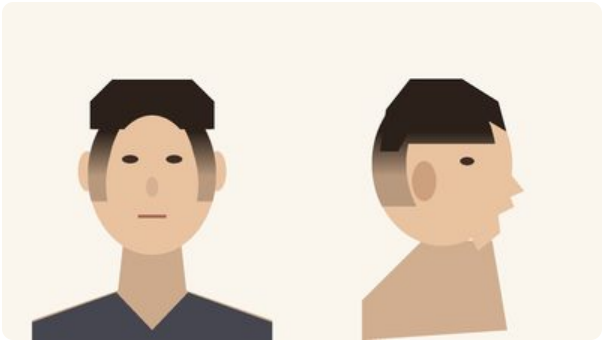
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 tapered low; top: scissor 3 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Comb the top straight back and cut to an even length with scissors over comb.
4. Blend the top into the sides so it lies smoothly without bumps.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Low taper with the top combed back.*

Styling: Apply light pomade to damp hair and comb back.

May not suit: Receding temples may be emphasized.



20. Taper Fade with Short Crop

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round

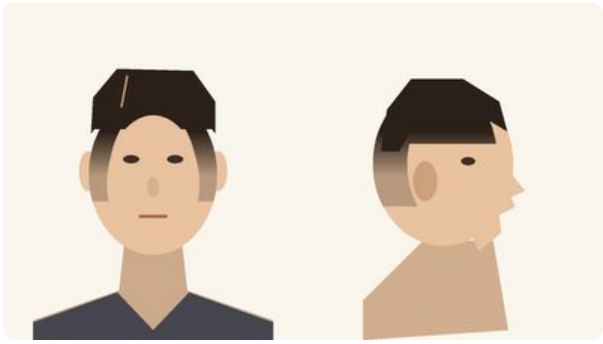
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #2 tapered; top: scissor 1 to 1.5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Cut the top short with texture and a straight fringe cut across the forehead.
5. Point-cut the fringe so it looks natural and not blunt.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Taper fade with a short French crop and a straight fringe.*

Styling: Apply sea salt spray or clay to give light separation.

May not suit: Very high foreheads may look more exposed.



21. Ivy League Taper

Intermediate | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round | heart

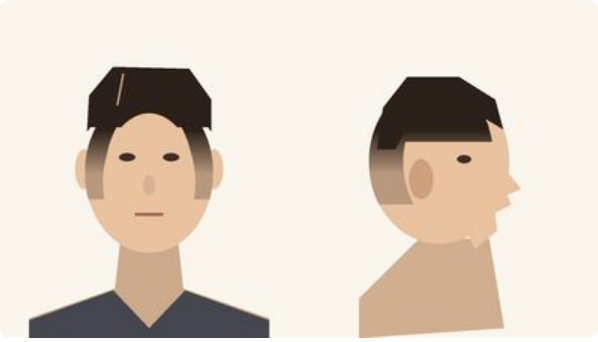
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #4 tapered; top: scissor 2.5 to 3 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Ivy league: tapered sides and a longer, brushed-over top.*

Styling: Brush with a light cream to keep it neat.

May not suit: Hair that grows very thick needs more thinning.



22. Taper with Shaped Beard Lineup

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | oval | square | round | oblong

Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 2 to 3 in; beard: #2 to #3

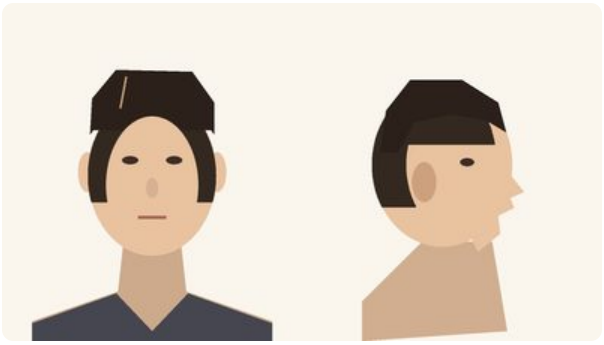
1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A taper on the sides blended into my beard, with a clean line-up.*

Styling: Light pomade for the top and beard balm for the beard.

May not suit: Patchy beards may not blend as cleanly.

Classic cuts



23. Classic Short Back and Sides

Beginner | Every 4 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | round | square | oblong | heart

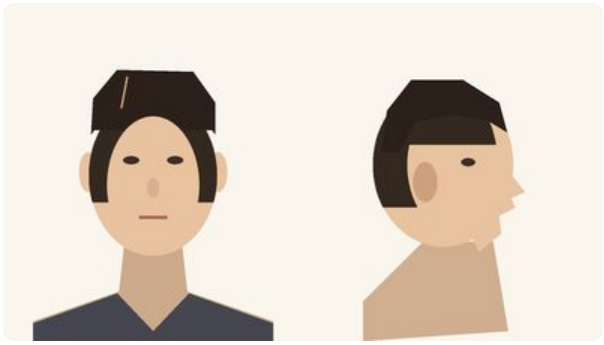
Guards and lengths: Sides: scissor over comb 0.5 to 1 in; top: scissor 2 to 3 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
4. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A classic short back and sides with a natural parting.*

Styling: Use a little pomade or cream and comb through.

May not suit: Works on most; very curly hair may need adaptation.



24. Executive Contour

Beginner | Every 3-4 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

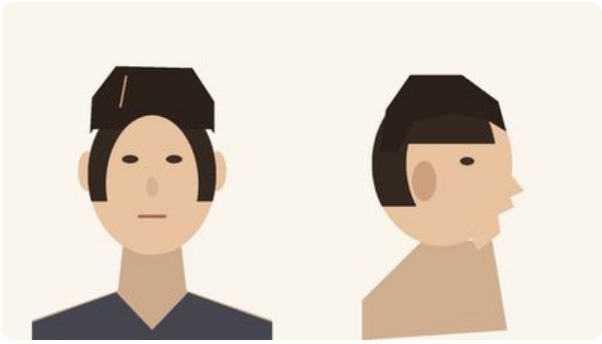
Guards and lengths: Sides: #3 to #4 blended; top: scissor 2.5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
4. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Executive contour: tapered sides with a conservative top.*

Styling: Dab a bit of cream or light pomade and comb over.

May not suit: Wavy hair needs more thinning to stay flat.



25. Side Part with Scissor Sides

Intermediate | Every 4-5 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | heart

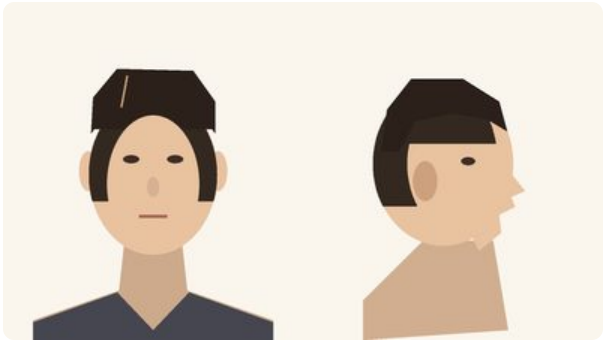
Guards and lengths: Sides: scissor over comb 1 in; top: scissor 3 to 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Cross-check by combing the opposite direction and trim any strays.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A neat side part with scissor-cut sides.*

Styling: Use a light water-based pomade and comb on damp hair.

May not suit: Hair with strong cowlicks at the part may resist.



26. Regular Gentleman's Cut

Beginner | Every 4-5 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | round | square | oblong | heart

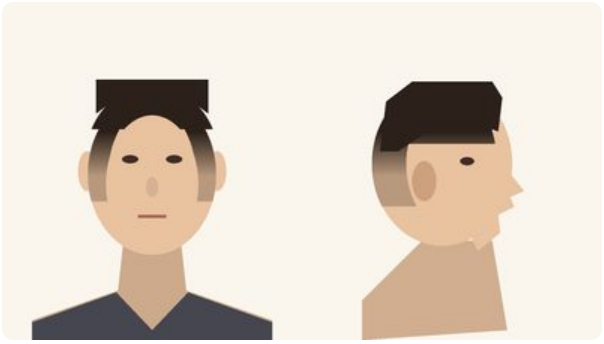
Guards and lengths: Sides: #4 clipper or scissor 0.5 in; top: scissor 2.5 to 3 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
4. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A regular, neat haircut, just a trim with a side part.*

Styling: A small amount of cream or pomade.

May not suit: Suits most clients; the safe cut.



27. Crew Cut

Beginner | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round | oblong

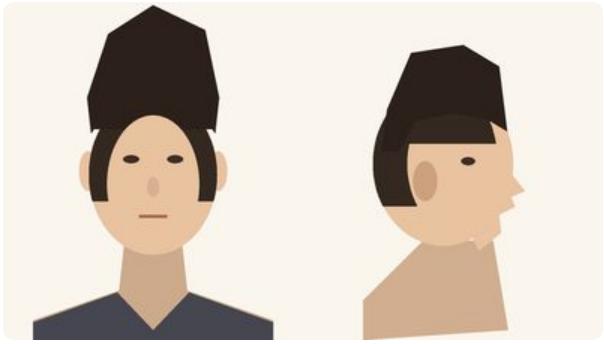
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3 tapered; top: #4 to #6 guard

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Comb the top straight up and cut it level with the comb as a guide.
4. Check the plane from the front and side and correct high spots.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A crew cut, short on the sides and a bit longer on top.*

Styling: Dab matte paste; push the front up lightly.

May not suit: A very round head shape shows lumps and bumps.



28. Classic Pompadour

Advanced | Every 3-4 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square

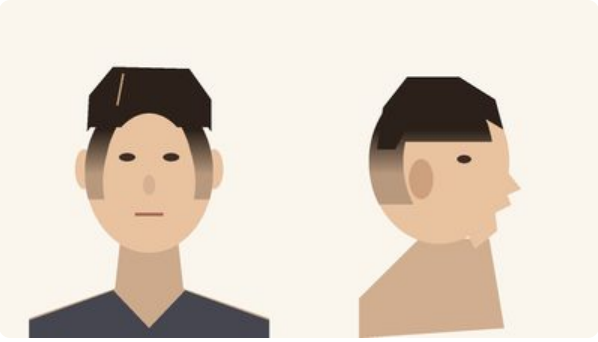
Guards and lengths: Sides: scissor over comb 0.5 to 1 in; top: scissor 4 to 5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Cross-check by combing the opposite direction and trim any strays.
4. Keep generous length at the front and cut it with a rising line toward the crown.
5. Connect the top to the sides with a blending pass so the shape flows.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A classic pompadour with scissor-cut sides.*

Styling: Blow-dry with a brush and hold with a medium pomade.

May not suit: Needs density at the front hairline.



29. Business Cut

Beginner | Every 3-4 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round | oblong | heart

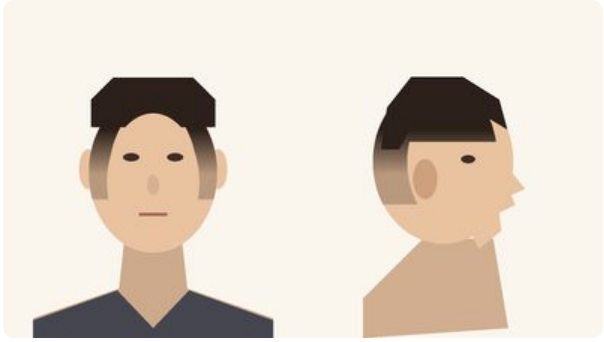
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #4 tapered; top: scissor 2 to 3 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
4. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A clean business cut: tidy, short sides and a soft part.*

Styling: Use a light cream for a natural finish.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



30. Princeton Cut

Intermediate | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round

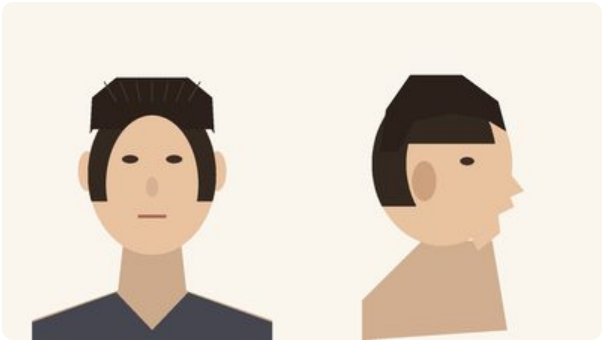
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 1.5 to 2 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Cut the top short with texture and a straight fringe cut across the forehead.
5. Point-cut the fringe so it looks natural and not blunt.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A Princeton: short sides and a textured, slightly longer top.*

Styling: Use texture paste and tousle from back to front.

May not suit: Not ideal for very curly hair without adjustments.



31. Brush Back

Beginner | Every 4-5 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

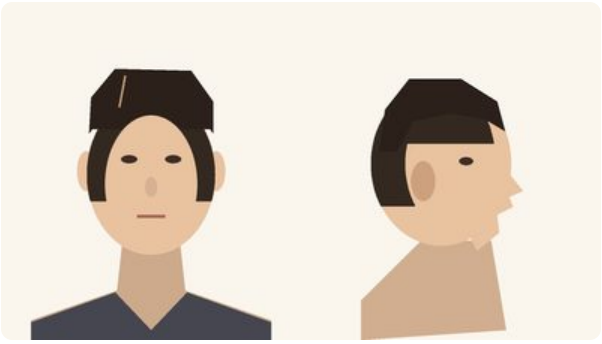
Guards and lengths: Sides: scissor 1 in; top: scissor 3 to 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Comb the top straight back and cut to an even length with scissors over comb.
4. Blend the top into the sides so it lies smoothly without bumps.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A natural brush back: sides cut short with scissors and the top left long.*

Styling: A light pomade and a brush.

May not suit: A strong widow's peak may show.



32. Short Ivy Cut

Intermediate | Every 3-4 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round | heart

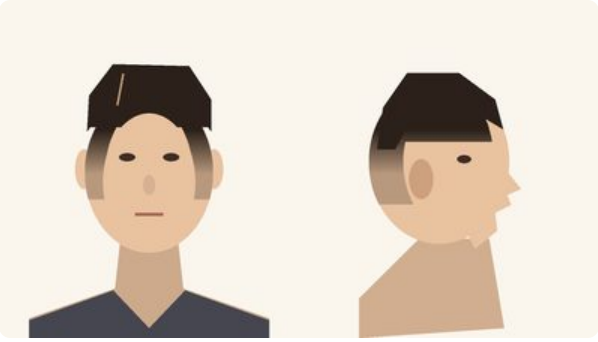
Guards and lengths: Sides: scissor over comb 0.5 in; top: scissor 2 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Cross-check by combing the opposite direction and trim any strays.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A short ivy cut with a faint side part.*

Styling: A dab of cream and a comb.

May not suit: Very thick hair can puff out on the sides.



33. Vintage Slick Side Part

Intermediate | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #4 tapered; top: scissor 3 to 4 in

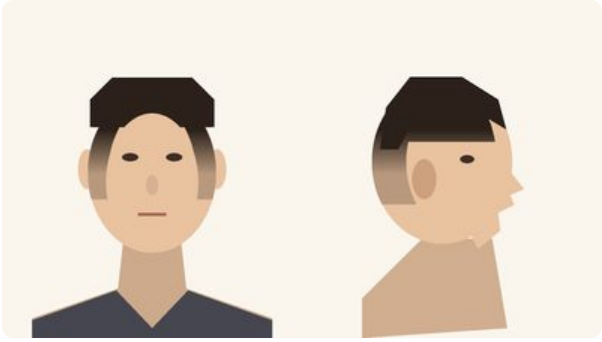
1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A vintage side part, combed and slick.*

Styling: A high-shine pomade, comb through damp hair.

May not suit: Thinning at the part line.

Crops and textures



34. French Crop

Beginner | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round | heart

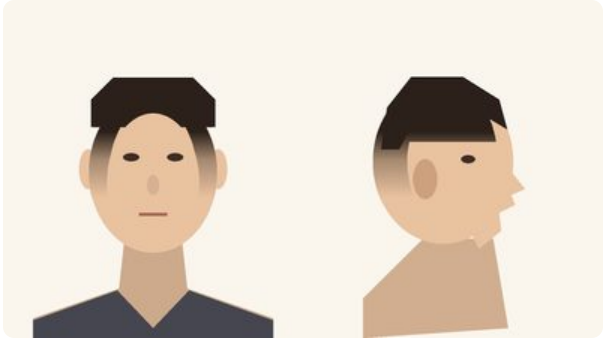
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 1 to 1.5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Cut the top short with texture and a straight fringe cut across the forehead.
4. Point-cut the fringe so it looks natural and not blunt.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A French crop with a short, straight fringe.*

Styling: Use matte clay and push the fringe forward.

May not suit: High foreheads become more visible.



35. Textured Crop with Low Fade

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | heart

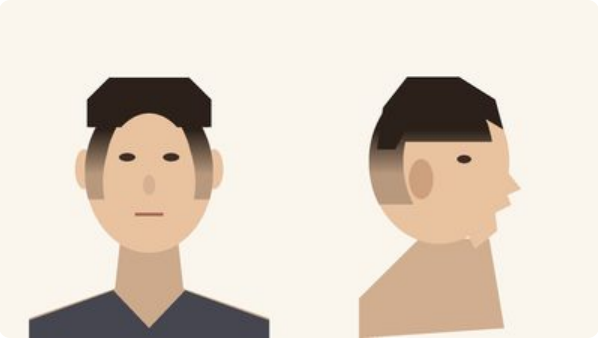
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended; top: scissor 1.5 to 2.5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
5. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A textured crop with a low fade.*

Styling: Apply sea salt spray, then clay.

May not suit: Very thin hair.



36. Messy Crop

Beginner | Every 3-4 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | heart

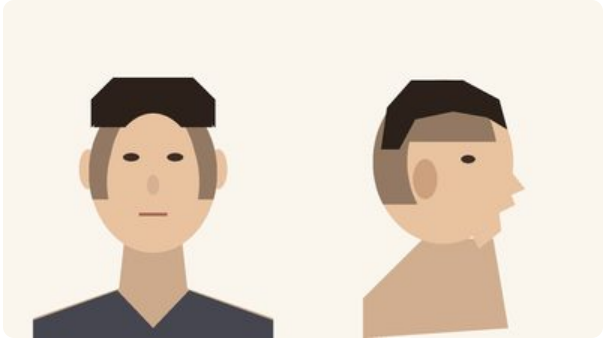
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 2 to 3 in, heavily point cut

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
4. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A messy crop, textured and not too neat.*

Styling: Texture paste, tousled with fingers.

May not suit: Very straight, heavy hair can be hard to texture.



37. Caesar Cut

Beginner | Every 2-3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round

Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3; top: scissor 0.75 to 1 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Run the clippers evenly over the sides and back with one guard, going against the grain.
3. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
4. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A Caesar: short, even and brushed forward with a short fringe.*

Styling: Small amount of paste, comb forward.

May not suit: Receding or uneven hairlines show.



38. Tousled Short Top

Beginner | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

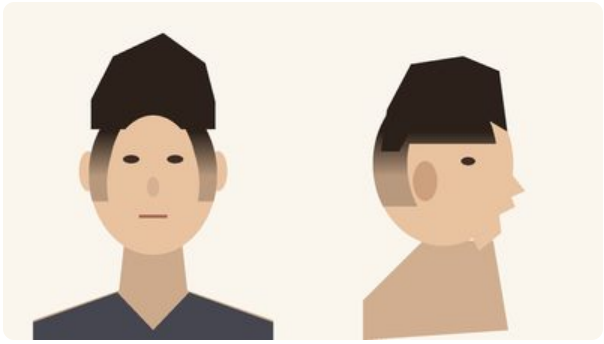
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 2 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Cut the top short and uneven with point cutting for separation.
4. Shorten the tips at varying lengths so the hair stands up in distinct pieces.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A short textured top with tousled styling.*

Styling: Dab a pinch of clay and ruffle.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



39. Textured Quiff

Intermediate | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong | heart

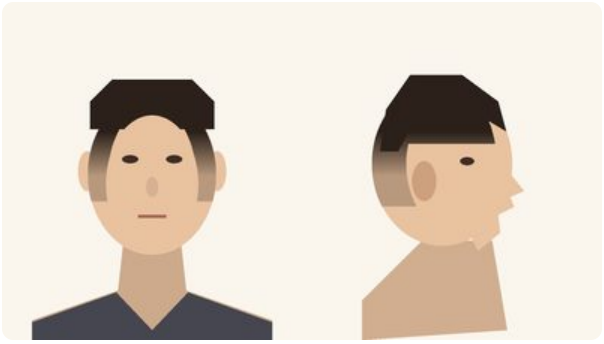
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 3 to 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Leave extra length at the front and cut the top with scissors over comb.
5. Texturize the front with point cutting so it lifts and sweeps up and back.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Textured quiff with a tapered side.*

Styling: Blow-dry up, then work in clay.

May not suit: Fine hair needs a volumizer.



40. Long Fringe Crop

Intermediate | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round | heart

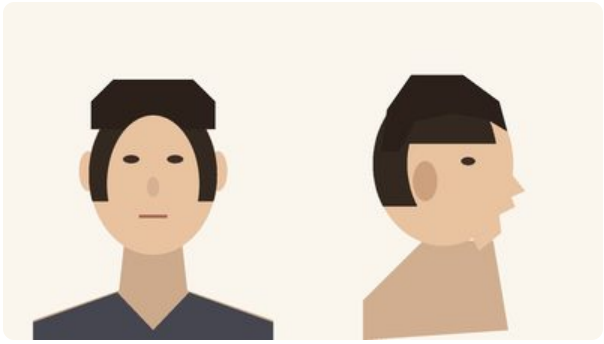
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 3 to 4 in with a long fringe

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Cut the top short with texture and a straight fringe cut across the forehead.
5. Point-cut the fringe so it looks natural and not blunt.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A crop with a longer fringe over the forehead.*

Styling: Cream or paste, finger-combed.

May not suit: Needs a manageable growth direction at the front.



41. Choppy Layered Crop

Intermediate | Every 4 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round

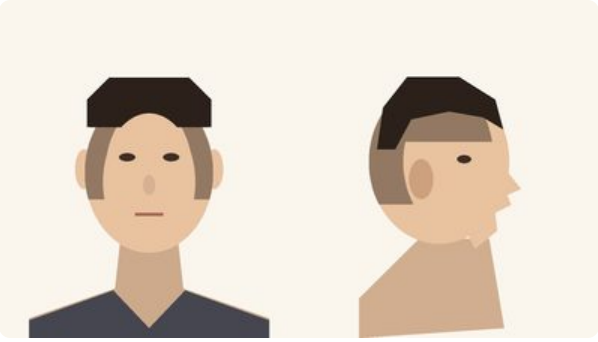
Guards and lengths: Sides: scissor over comb 0.75 in; top: scissor 3 in, point cut

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Cross-check by combing the opposite direction and trim any strays.
4. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
5. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A choppy, layered top with short, tidy sides.*

Styling: Sea salt spray plus clay.

May not suit: Fine hair may look too thin when layered.



42. Short Cap Crop

Beginner | Every 2-3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square

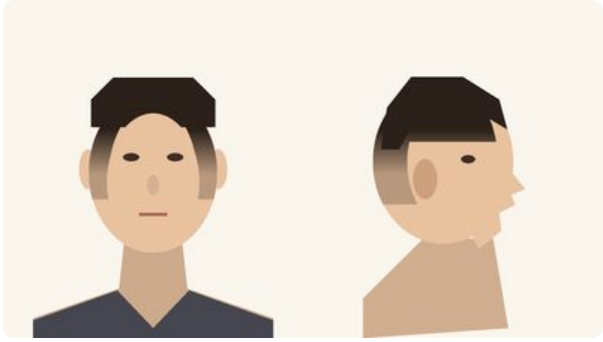
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2; top: scissor 1 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Run the clippers evenly over the sides and back with one guard, going against the grain.
3. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
4. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A short, easy crop with minimal upkeep.*

Styling: Almost none; a bit of paste if desired.

May not suit: Round faces may want more height.



43. Rough Fringe Crop

Beginner | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | heart

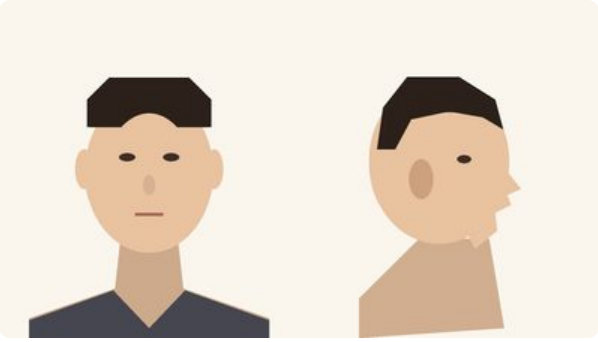
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 2 in, rough cut

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
4. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A rough fringe with a cropped top.*

Styling: Matte paste and loose finger styling.

May not suit: Very straight hair with a forehead cowlick.



44. Disconnected Crop

Intermediate | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round

Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 or #2; top: scissor 2 to 3 in; disconnected

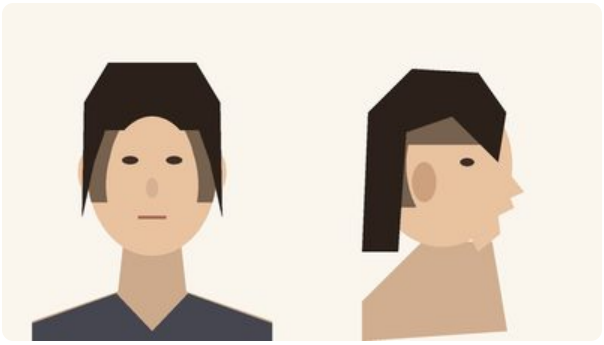
1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Section the top away with clips along the parting line.
3. Clip the sides short with one guard and no blending, keeping a clean disconnection line.
4. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
5. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A disconnected crop: short sides and a longer textured top.*

Styling: Clay or paste for texture.

May not suit: Very fine hair can look too light.

Long and medium



45. Medium Length Flow

Beginner | Every 6-8 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong | heart

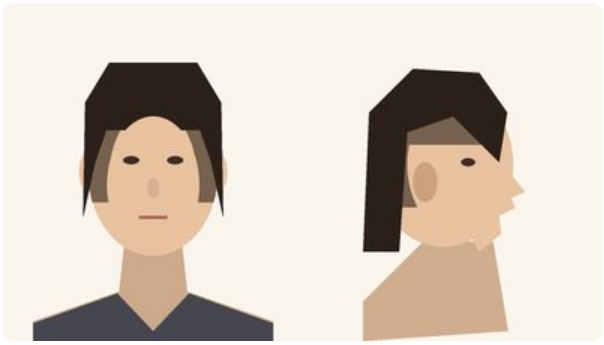
Guards and lengths: Sides: scissor, natural length 4 to 5 in; top: 5 to 6 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Leave the sides at natural length and use scissors over comb to remove bulk.
3. Cut the length to a single line with the hair hanging naturally.
4. Add soft layers around the face to remove weight without losing length.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A medium-length flow, trimmed and layered lightly.*

Styling: Use a light leave-in and air dry.

May not suit: Hair that frizzes may need a smoothing product.



46. Shoulder Length Layered

Intermediate | Every 8-10 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | oval | square | heart

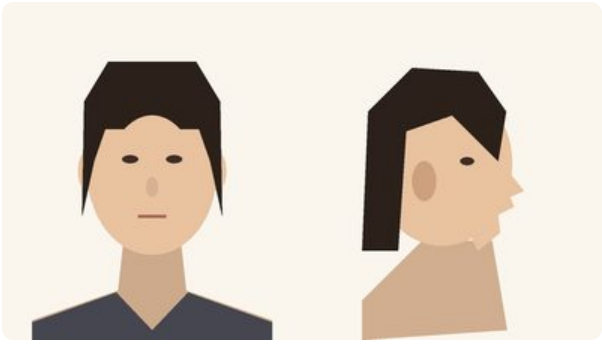
Guards and lengths: Length: shoulders; layers: scissor, 1 to 2 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Leave the sides at natural length and use scissors over comb to remove bulk.
3. Trim around the ears and nape so the outline is tidy.
4. Cut the length to a single line with the hair hanging naturally.
5. Add soft layers around the face to remove weight without losing length.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A shoulder-length cut with soft layers.*

Styling: Use a leave-in conditioner and air dry.

May not suit: Very fine hair may look thin at the ends.



47. Man Bun Undercut

Intermediate | Every 4 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | oval | square | oblong | round

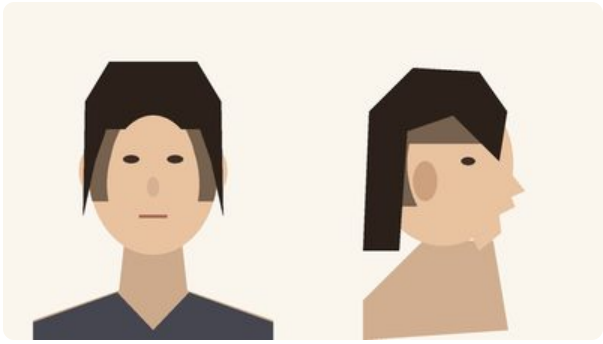
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2; top: 5 to 8 in kept long for tying

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Section the top away with clips along the parting line.
3. Clip the sides short with one guard and no blending, keeping a clean disconnection line.
4. Cut the length to a single line with the hair hanging naturally.
5. Add soft layers around the face to remove weight without losing length.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Undercut on the sides, and keep length on top for a man bun.*

Styling: A bit of pomade or cream for flyaways.

May not suit: Needs enough length to be tied.



48. Long Layers with Side Part

Beginner | Every 8 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | heart | oblong

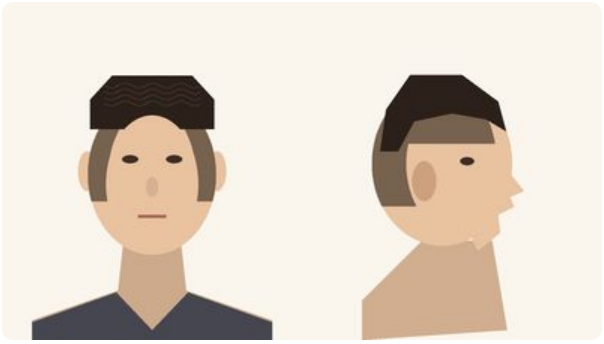
Guards and lengths: Length: below the chin; layers: scissor, 1 to 2 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Leave the sides at natural length and use scissors over comb to remove bulk.
3. Cut the length to a single line with the hair hanging naturally.
4. Add soft layers around the face to remove weight without losing length.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Long layers with a side part.*

Styling: Use a light styling cream.

May not suit: Oblong faces may look longer with long straight hair.



49. Surfer Cut

Beginner | Every 6-8 weeks | wavy | curly | oval | square | heart

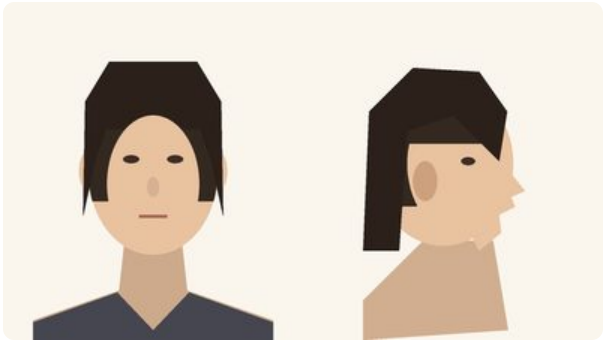
Guards and lengths: Length: ears to chin; layers: scissor, 2 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Leave the sides at natural length and use scissors over comb to remove bulk.
3. Cut the top with the hair relaxed and natural, working with the wave direction.
4. Keep length even enough that waves can stack without gaps.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A beachy, shaggy surfer cut.*

Styling: Sea salt spray and air dry.

May not suit: Straight, flat hair will not give the texture.



50. Shaggy Layers

Intermediate | Every 6 weeks | wavy | curly | oval | square | round | heart

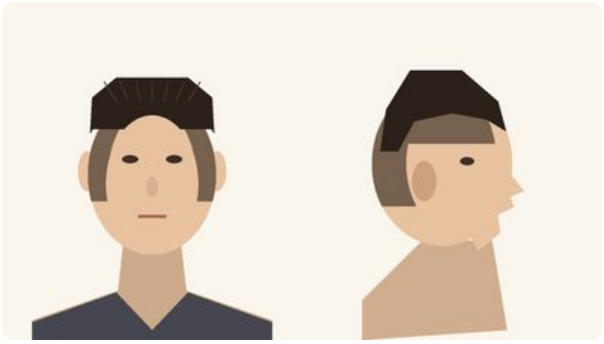
Guards and lengths: Sides: scissor 2 in; top: scissor 3 to 4 in, point cut

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Cross-check by combing the opposite direction and trim any strays.
4. Cut the length to a single line with the hair hanging naturally.
5. Add soft layers around the face to remove weight without losing length.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Shaggy layers with lots of movement.*

Styling: Texture spray and finger-comb.

May not suit: Very fine hair loses density with heavy layers.



51. Slicked Long Hair

Beginner | Every 8 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

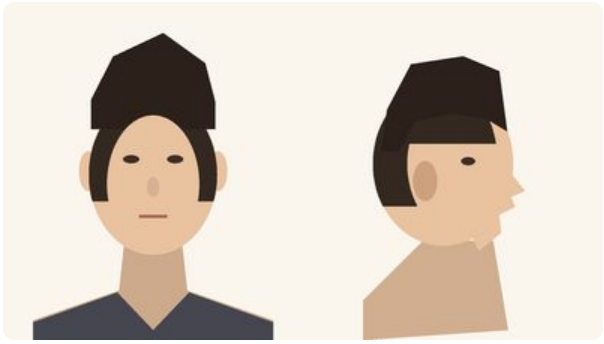
Guards and lengths: Length: 5 to 7 in; no guards

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Leave the sides at natural length and use scissors over comb to remove bulk.
3. Comb the top straight back and cut to an even length with scissors over comb.
4. Blend the top into the sides so it lies smoothly without bumps.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Long hair combed back clean.*

Styling: A water-based pomade and a comb.

May not suit: Receding hairlines will show.



52. Medium Quiff with Scissor Sides

Intermediate | Every 4 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

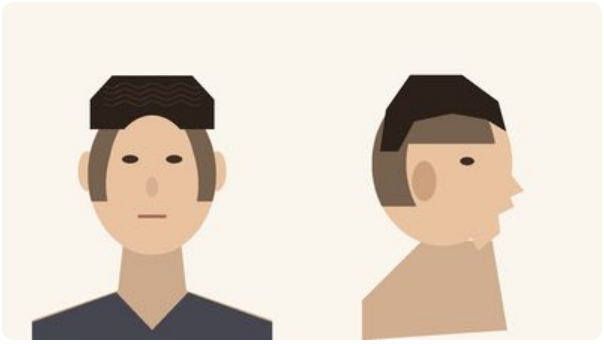
Guards and lengths: Sides: scissor 1 to 1.5 in; top: scissor 3 to 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Cross-check by combing the opposite direction and trim any strays.
4. Leave extra length at the front and cut the top with scissors over comb.
5. Texturize the front with point cutting so it lifts and sweeps up and back.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A medium quiff with scissor-cut sides.*

Styling: Blow-dry up and finish with paste.

May not suit: Fine hair needs help with lift.



53. Textured Medium Flow

Beginner | Every 6 weeks | wavy | oval | square | heart

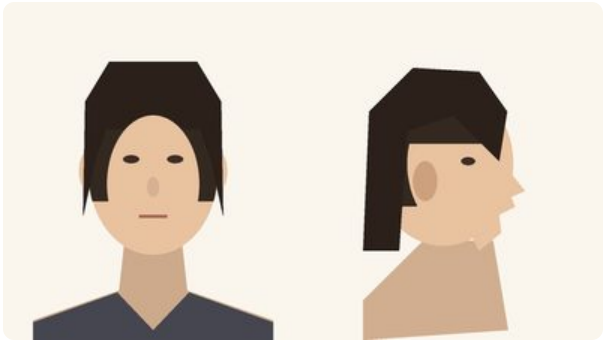
Guards and lengths: Length: sides scissor 2 in; top: 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Leave the sides at natural length and use scissors over comb to remove bulk.
3. Cut the top with the hair relaxed and natural, working with the wave direction.
4. Keep length even enough that waves can stack without gaps.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A medium flow with texture and bounce.*

Styling: A salt spray and diffuse.

May not suit: Heavy, straight hair needs layering.



54. Layered Mullet

Advanced | Every 5-6 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | oval | square | heart

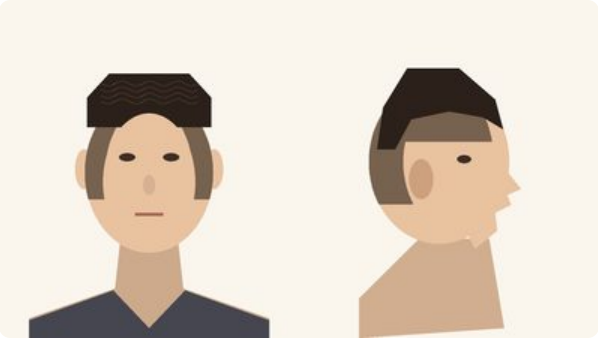
Guards and lengths: Sides: scissor 1 to 2 in; back: 5 to 6 in; top: 3 to 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Cross-check by combing the opposite direction and trim any strays.
4. Cut the length to a single line with the hair hanging naturally.
5. Add soft layers around the face to remove weight without losing length.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A modern, layered mullet with shorter sides and a longer back.*

Styling: Apply a cream and let air dry.

May not suit: Thin napes show poorly.



55. Wavy Collar-Length Cut

Beginner | Every 8 weeks | wavy | curly | oval | square | heart | round

Guards and lengths: Length: at the collar; trim: scissor, 0.5 in at the ends

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Leave the sides at natural length and use scissors over comb to remove bulk.
3. Cut the top with the hair relaxed and natural, working with the wave direction.
4. Keep length even enough that waves can stack without gaps.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Collar-length waves, just trimmed.*

Styling: A curl cream and air dry.

May not suit: Very straight hair will not get wavy.

Curly and wavy



56. Curly Top with Skin Fade

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | curly | coily | oval | square | round | heart

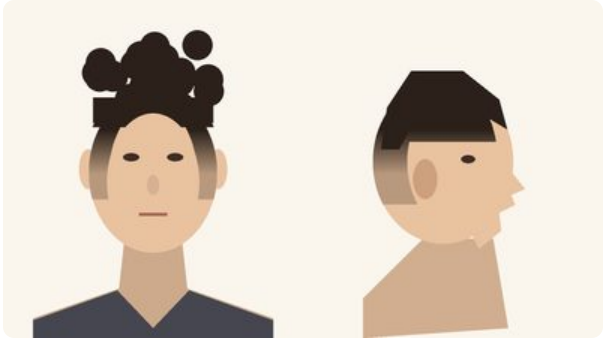
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended; top: scissor 2 to 3 in curls

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
5. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Skin fade with my curls kept on top.*

Styling: Curl cream on damp hair and finger define.

May not suit: Very tight curls look shorter when dry.



57. Taper Fade with Twist Sponge Top

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | coily | oval | square | round

Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 1.5 to 2 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
5. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A taper with a sponge-twist-ready top.*

Styling: Use a sponge with curl cream.

May not suit: Needs enough length to twist.



58. Natural Curly Mop

Beginner | Every 8 weeks | wavy | curly | oval | square | heart

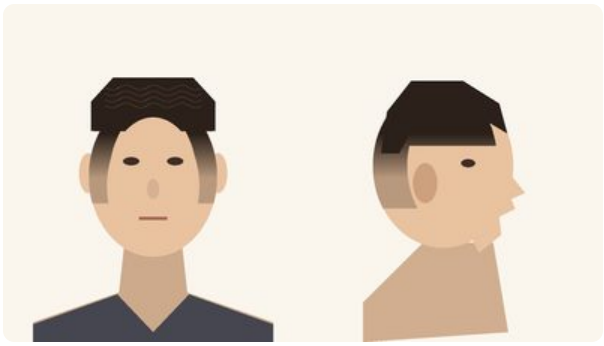
Guards and lengths: Sides: scissor 3 in; top: scissor 4 to 5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Leave the sides at natural length and use scissors over comb to remove bulk.
3. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
4. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A natural curly mop, just trimmed.*

Styling: Curl cream and diffuse.

May not suit: Very fine curls may lose shape.



59. Wave Cut with Low Taper

Intermediate | Every 3 weeks | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square | round

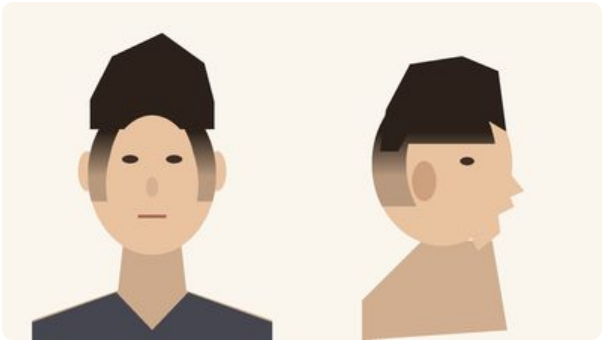
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1.5 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 1 to 2 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Cut the top with the hair relaxed and natural, working with the wave direction.
5. Keep length even enough that waves can stack without gaps.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A short wave cut with a low taper.*

Styling: Use a wave-defining cream and brush.

May not suit: Hair needs a visible wave pattern.



60. Loose Curl Quiff

Intermediate | Every 3 weeks | wavy | curly | oval | square | oblong

Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3 tapered; top: scissor 3 to 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Leave extra length at the front and cut the top with scissors over comb.
5. Texturize the front with point cutting so it lifts and sweeps up and back.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A loose curly quiff.*

Styling: Cream and gentle blow-dry.

May not suit: Tight curls will not lift as loosely.



61. Curly Fringe with Fade

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | curly | coily | oval | square | heart

Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended; top: scissor 2 in curl fringe

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
5. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Mid fade with a curly fringe.*

Styling: Curl cream on damp hair.

May not suit: Forehead curls can shrink up.



62. Afro Shape-Up

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | coily | oval | square | round | heart | oblong

Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3 tapered; top: 3 to 4 in picked out

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
5. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A rounded afro with a clean line-up.*

Styling: Pick out and spray with moisture.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adapt the shape to the head.



63. Twist Out with Taper

Advanced | Every 3 weeks | coily | curly | oval | square | round

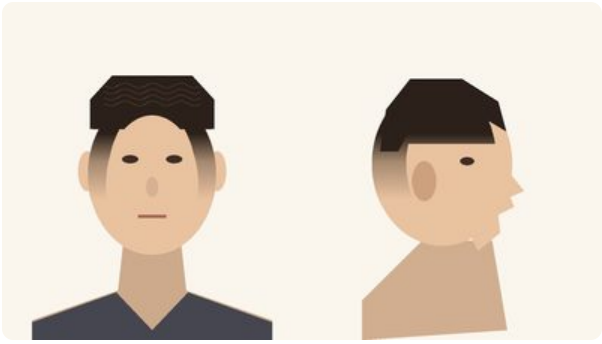
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 tapered; top: 4 to 6 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
5. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A taper with twist-out styling on top.*

Styling: Moisturizer and a twisting cream.

May not suit: Needs time and styling skill.



64. Wavy Crop with Low Fade

Beginner | Every 2-3 weeks | wavy | curly | oval | square | heart

Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended; top: scissor 1.5 to 2.5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Cut the top with the hair relaxed and natural, working with the wave direction.
4. Keep length even enough that waves can stack without gaps.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A short wavy top with a low fade.*

Styling: Light mousse and air dry.

May not suit: Flat, straight hair.



65. Curly Undercut

Intermediate | Every 3-4 weeks | curly | coily | oval | square | round

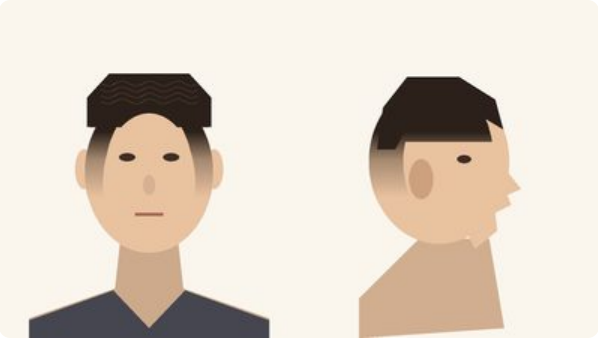
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 no blend; top: scissor 3 to 4 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Section the top away with clips along the parting line.
3. Clip the sides short with one guard and no blending, keeping a clean disconnection line.
4. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
5. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A curly top with an undercut on the sides.*

Styling: Curl cream and diffuse.

May not suit: Strong contrast may suit rounder faces less.



66. Low Fade Waves with Line Up

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | coily | curly | oval | square | round | oblong

Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #1 blended; top: scissor 0.5 to 1 in

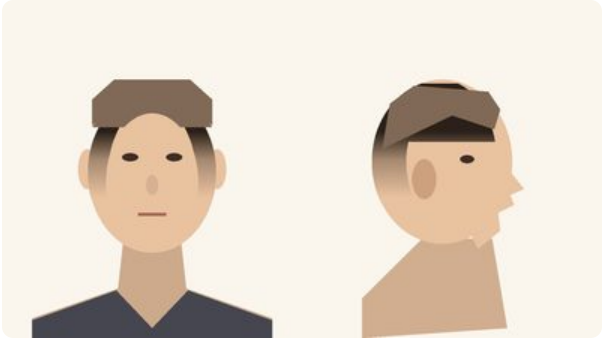
1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Cut the top with the hair relaxed and natural, working with the wave direction.
5. Keep length even enough that waves can stack without gaps.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A low fade with crisp waves and a line-up.*

Styling: Moisturizer, brush, and a durag at night.

May not suit: Needs a regular brushing routine.

Buzz and short



67. Buzz Cut with Fade

Beginner | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square | oblong

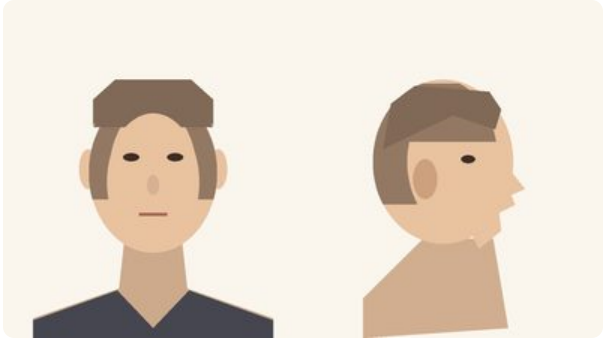
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #1 blended; top: #3 guard

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
4. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Buzz cut with a low fade on the sides.*

Styling: Skip product; moisturize the scalp.

May not suit: Uneven head shapes may show.



68. Even Buzz Cut

Beginner | Every 2-3 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square | oblong | heart

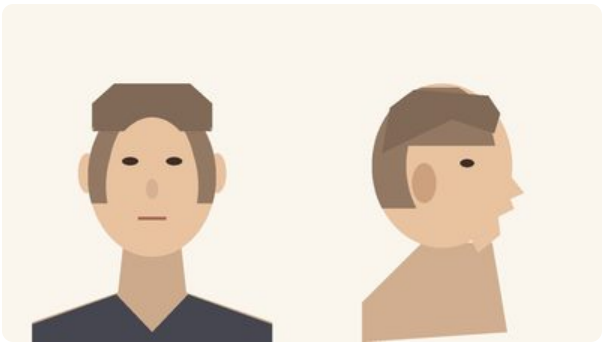
Guards and lengths: All over: #2 to #3 guard

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Run the clippers evenly over the sides and back with one guard, going against the grain.
3. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
4. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A buzz cut with a #3 all over.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Scars and head lumps are more visible.



69. Induction Cut

Beginner | Every 1-2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

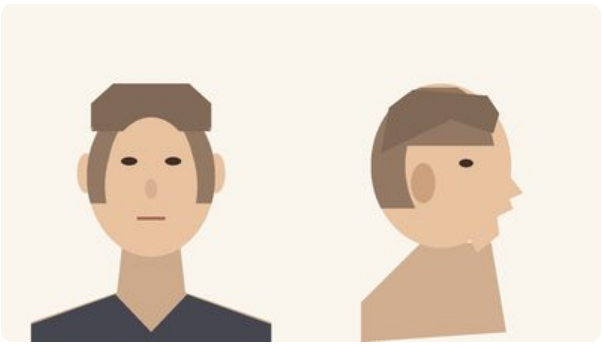
Guards and lengths: All over: #1 guard

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Run the clippers evenly over the sides and back with one guard, going against the grain.
3. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
4. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *An induction cut, very short all over.*

Styling: Scalp moisturizer.

May not suit: Needs sun protection.



70. Butch Cut

Beginner | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square | oblong

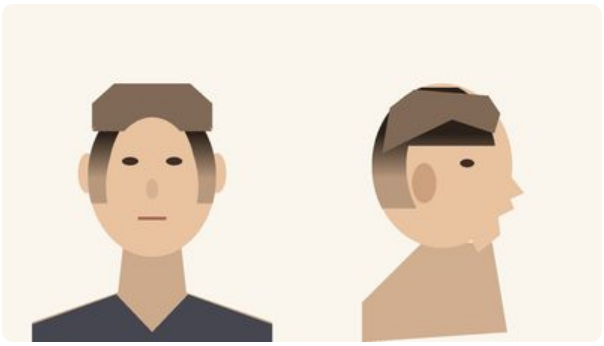
Guards and lengths: All over: #4 to #5 guard

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Run the clippers evenly over the sides and back with one guard, going against the grain.
3. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
4. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A butch cut, an even short cut all over with a longer guard.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



71. Buzz with Taper

Beginner | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square | round

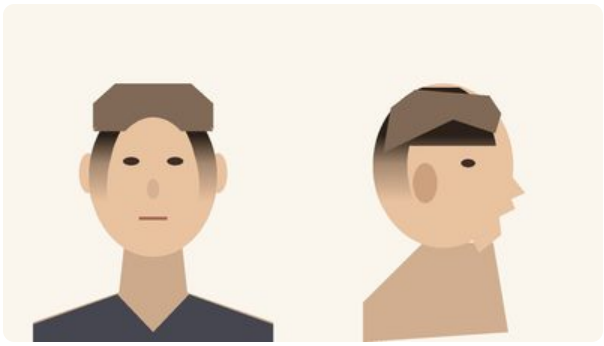
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #2; top: #4 guard

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
4. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A buzz with a taper at the sides.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



72. Skin Buzz (Bald Look)

Intermediate | Every 2-3 days | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

Guards and lengths: All over: skin shave with foil shaver or razor

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
5. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A fully shaved head.*

Styling: Moisturizer and sunscreen.

May not suit: Razor skin care needed.



73. Short Spiky Top Buzz Sides

Beginner | Every 2-3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

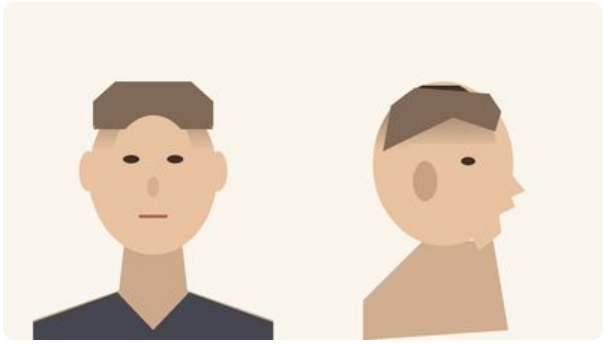
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 or #2; top: scissor 1 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Run the clippers evenly over the sides and back with one guard, going against the grain.
3. Cut the top short and uneven with point cutting for separation.
4. Shorten the tips at varying lengths so the hair stands up in distinct pieces.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Short spikes with buzzed sides.*

Styling: Light gel or clay.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



74. Recruit-Style Buzz

Intermediate | Every 1-2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square | oblong

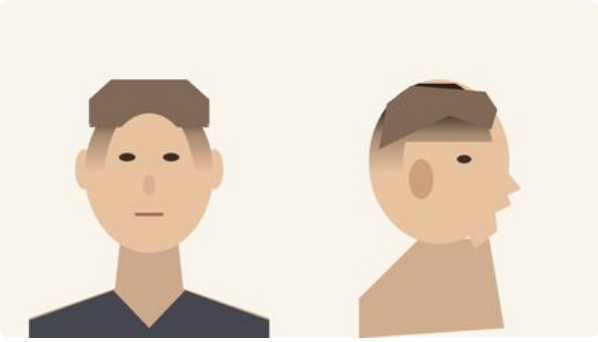
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #1 high; top: #2

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a high fade line near the top of the head, around the temple.
3. Blend with light flicks and a mid-length guard so the high line melts into the top.
4. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
5. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A tight high-and-tight buzz style.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: May look severe on thin faces.



75. Number 2 Faded Buzz

Beginner | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

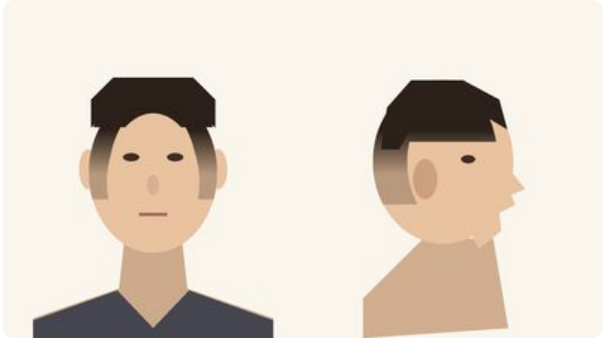
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #1 blended; top: #2

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
4. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A #2 on top with a faded side.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



76. Short Textured Buzz

Beginner | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round

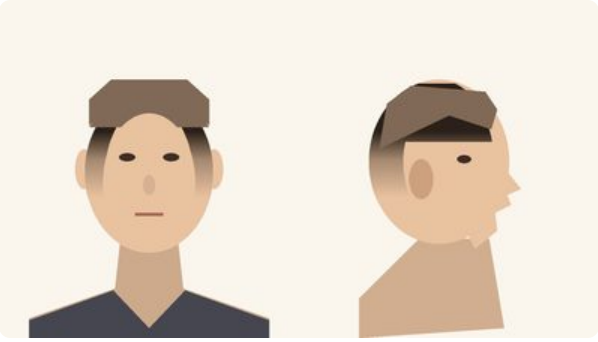
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 tapered; top: #5 to #6 guard

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
4. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A slightly longer buzz with texture.*

Styling: A little matte clay.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



77. Buzz with Beard Fade

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square | oblong

Guards and lengths: Head: #2; beard: skin to #3 blended

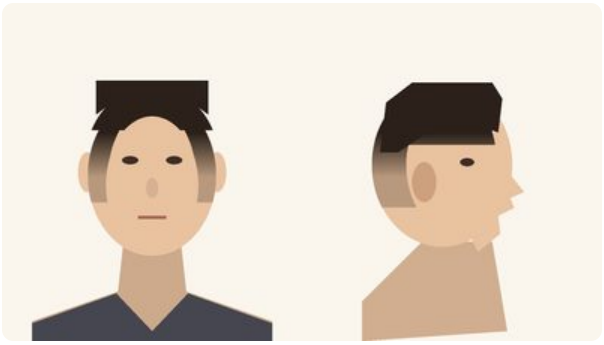
1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
5. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A buzz cut, with the beard faded.*

Styling: Beard oil.

May not suit: Patchy beards may not blend.

Flat tops and high tops



78. Classic Flat Top

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square

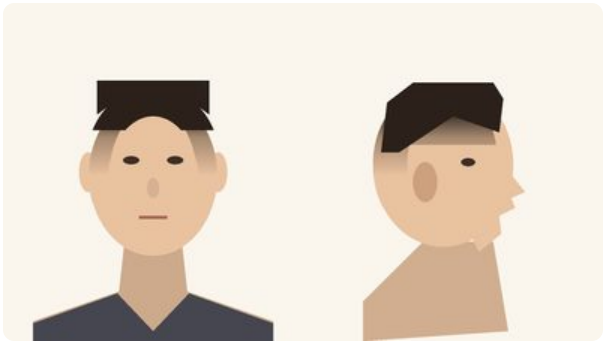
Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 tapered; top: comb, cut level at 1 to 1.5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Comb the top straight up and cut it level with the comb as a guide.
5. Check the plane from the front and side and correct high spots.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A classic flat top.*

Styling: Use firm wax to keep it flat.

May not suit: Soft hair will not stay up.



79. Flat Top with Skin Fade

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square

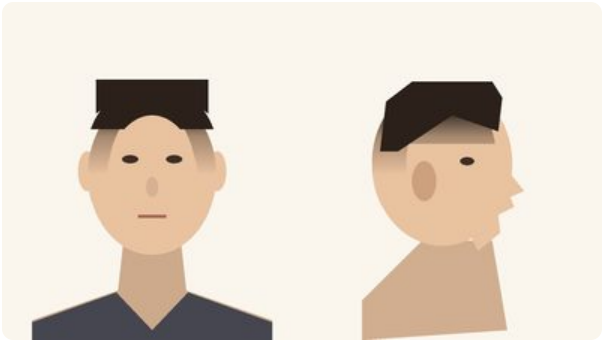
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended; top: 1 to 1.5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Comb the top straight up and cut it level with the comb as a guide.
5. Check the plane from the front and side and correct high spots.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A flat top with a skin fade.*

Styling: Firm wax and comb.

May not suit: Very curly, short hair needs adjustments.



80. High Top Fade

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | coily | curly | oval | square | round | oblong

Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended; top: 3 to 5 in, shaped

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Comb the top straight up and cut it level with the comb as a guide.
5. Check the plane from the front and side and correct high spots.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A high top fade with a squared top.*

Styling: Pick and shape; moisturize.

May not suit: Needs enough height of hair.



81. Rounded High Top

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | coily | curly | oval | square | round

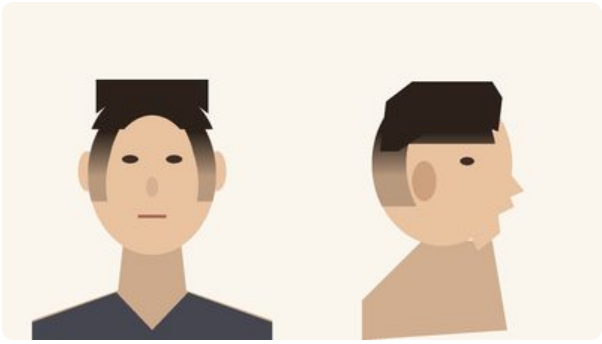
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended; top: 3 to 4 in rounded

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
5. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A rounded high top.*

Styling: Pick and moisturizer.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



82. Flat Top with Taper

Intermediate | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | coily | oval | square

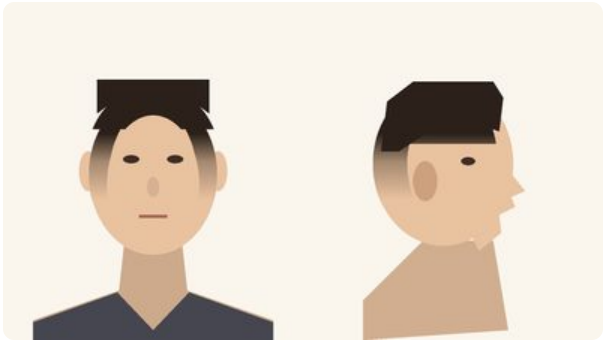
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3 tapered; top: 1.5 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Comb the top straight up and cut it level with the comb as a guide.
5. Check the plane from the front and side and correct high spots.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A flat top with a gentle taper.*

Styling: Medium hold wax.

May not suit: Large heads may look boxy.



83. Box Cut Flat Top

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | coily | curly | oval | square

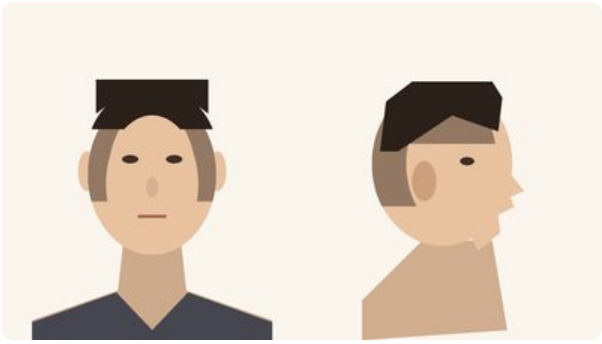
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #1 blended; top: 1 to 2 in squared

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Comb the top straight up and cut it level with the comb as a guide.
5. Check the plane from the front and side and correct high spots.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A box cut flat top with precisely square edges.*

Styling: Pick and wax.

May not suit: Needs a symmetrical head shape.



84. Short Flat Top

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

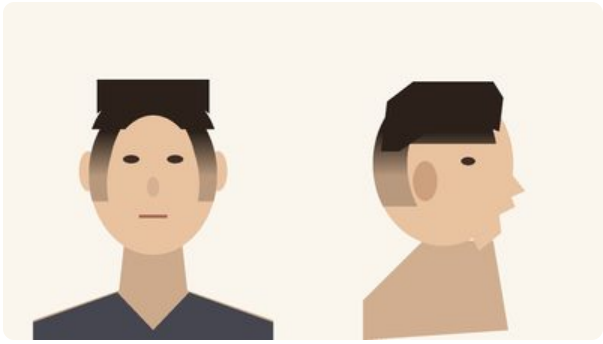
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2; top: 0.5 to 1 in flat

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Run the clippers evenly over the sides and back with one guard, going against the grain.
3. Run a hand over the cut to find uneven spots and re-clip them.
4. Comb the top straight up and cut it level with the comb as a guide.
5. Check the plane from the front and side and correct high spots.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A short flat top with an even buzz at the sides.*

Styling: A little wax.

May not suit: Very low density.



85. Tall Flat Top

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | coily | curly | straight | oval | square

Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 tapered; top: 2 to 3 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Comb the top straight up and cut it level with the comb as a guide.
5. Check the plane from the front and side and correct high spots.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A taller flat top.*

Styling: Firm pomade.

May not suit: Elongates long faces.



86. High Top Twists

Advanced | Every 2-3 weeks | coily | oval | square | round | oblong

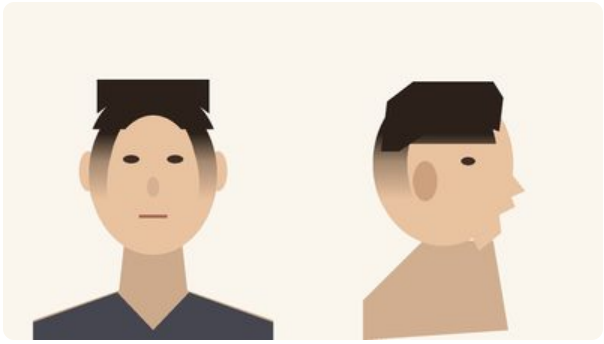
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2; top: 3 to 5 in twists

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
5. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *High top with short twists.*

Styling: Twisting cream.

May not suit: Needs maintenance.



87. Curved Flat Top

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | coily | oval | square

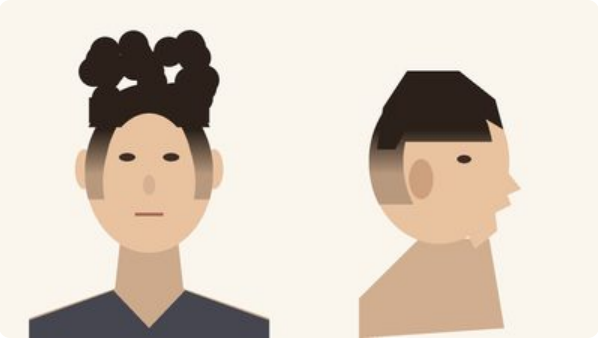
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #1 blended; top: 1.5 in curved

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Comb the top straight up and cut it level with the comb as a guide.
5. Check the plane from the front and side and correct high spots.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A flat top with a gentle curve.*

Styling: Firm wax.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



88. Rounded Top Taper

Intermediate | Every 3 weeks | coily | curly | oval | square | round

Guards and lengths: Sides: #1 to #3 tapered; top: 2 to 3 in

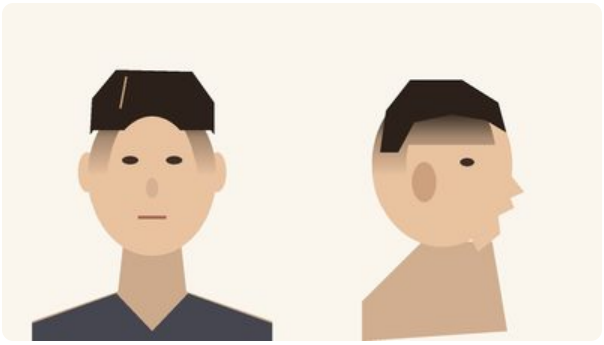
1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
5. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A rounded top with a taper.*

Styling: Moisturizing cream.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.

Beard-friendly and combos



89. Fade into Full Beard

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square | oblong

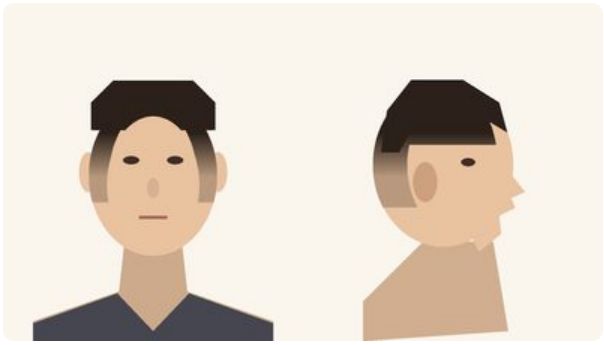
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2 blended; beard: #3 to #5 fading into the sideburn

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A fade that blends into my full beard.*

Styling: Beard oil and light pomade.

May not suit: Weak beard growth.



90. Taper into Short Boxed Beard

Intermediate | Every 2-3 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | oval | square | heart

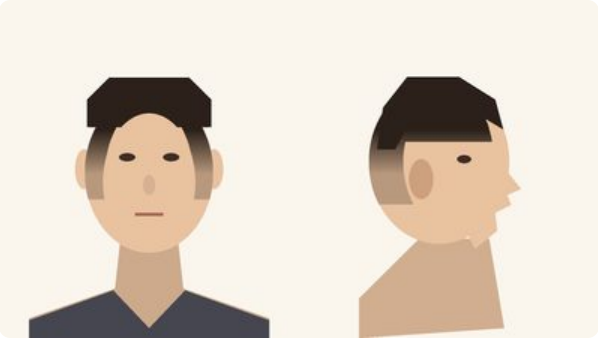
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3 tapered; beard: #2 to #4 boxed

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Soften the taper with a lever-open pass or clipper over comb so the length graduates evenly.
4. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
5. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A taper and a short boxed beard.*

Styling: Beard balm.

May not suit: Patchy cheeks.



91. Stubble Beard with Crop

Beginner | Every 2-3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | heart | oblong

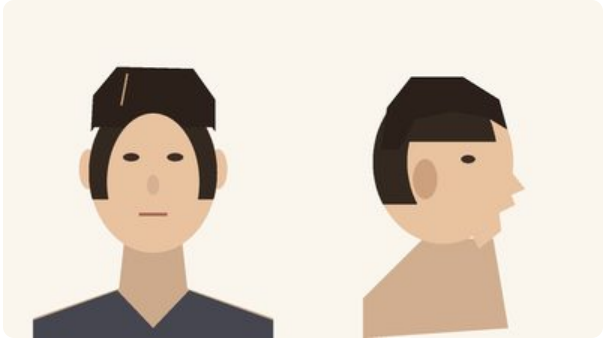
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 tapered; beard: #1 to #2

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
4. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A short crop and a stubble beard.*

Styling: A pinch of clay.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



92. Classic Cut with Neat Goatee

Beginner | Every 3-4 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | round

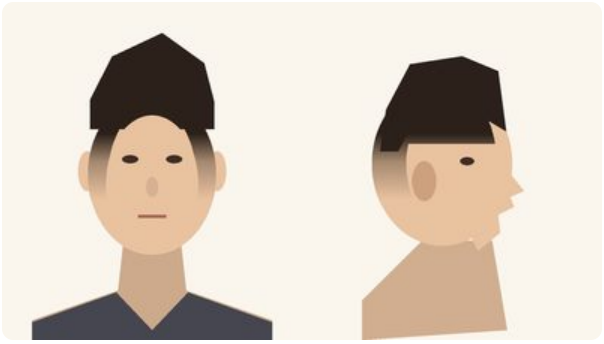
Guards and lengths: Hair: scissor 2 in; goatee: #3 trimmed

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
4. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A classic cut with a neat goatee.*

Styling: Light pomade.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



93. Textured Quiff with Beard

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

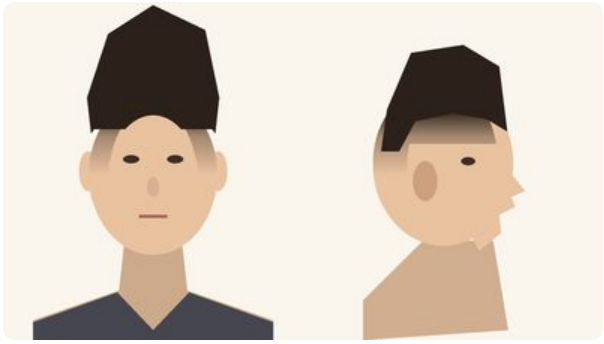
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2; beard: #3 to #5

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Leave extra length at the front and cut the top with scissors over comb.
5. Texturize the front with point cutting so it lifts and sweeps up and back.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A quiff with a faded beard.*

Styling: Paste and beard oil.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



94. Pompadour with Full Beard

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square

Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2; beard: #4 to #6

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Keep generous length at the front and cut it with a rising line toward the crown.
5. Connect the top to the sides with a blending pass so the shape flows.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A pompadour with a full beard.*

Styling: Pomade and beard balm.

May not suit: A very long face.



95. Curly Top with Beard Fade

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | curly | coily | oval | square | round

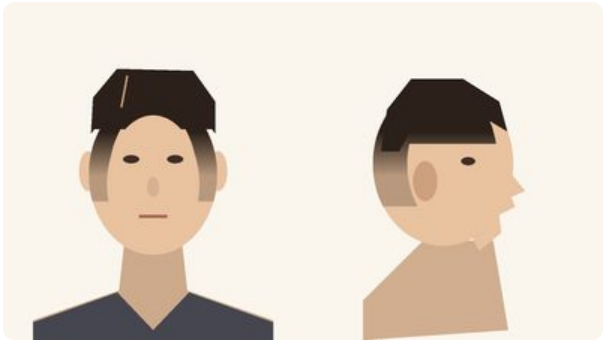
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2; beard: skin to #3

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Cut the top dry or damp in sections, following the curl pattern and not stretching the curl.
5. Shape the outline in a rounded form and remove bulk with light point cutting.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Curly top with the beard faded in.*

Styling: Curl cream and beard oil.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



96. Short Back and Sides with Mustache

Beginner | Every 3 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square

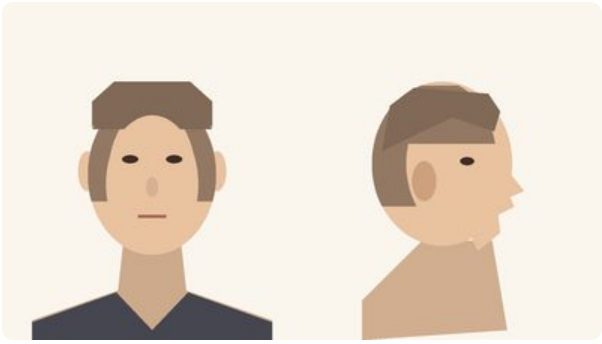
Guards and lengths: Sides: #2 to #3; mustache: scissor trimmed

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Clip the sides and neckline with a short guard, leaving the most length at the top of the sides.
3. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
4. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A neat cut with a tidy mustache.*

Styling: Mustache wax if wanted.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



97. Buzz with Circle Beard

Beginner | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square | oblong

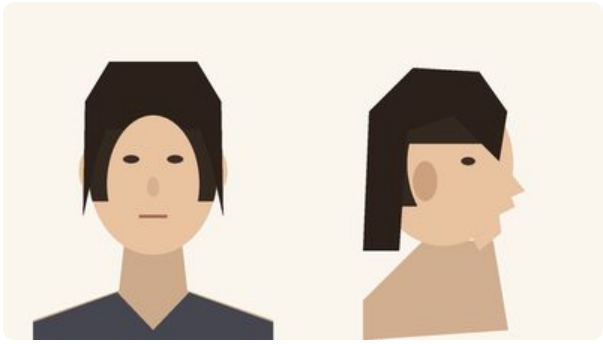
Guards and lengths: Head: #2; beard: #2 to #3 circle

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Run the clippers evenly over the sides and back with one guard, going against the grain.
3. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
4. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A buzz with a circle beard.*

Styling: Beard oil.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



98. Medium Flow with Beard

Beginner | Every 6 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square | oblong

Guards and lengths: Hair: scissor 4 to 5 in; beard: #5 to #6 natural line

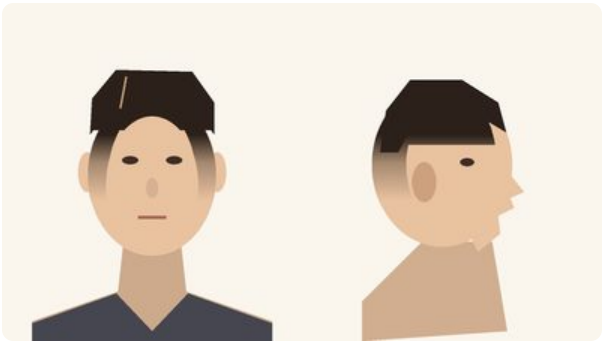
1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Use scissor over comb to cut the sides to length, working from the nape upward.
3. Cut the length to a single line with the hair hanging naturally.
4. Add soft layers around the face to remove weight without losing length.
5. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *Medium hair with a natural beard.*

Styling: Beard balm.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.

Designs and parts



99. Hard Part Razor Line

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | oval | square

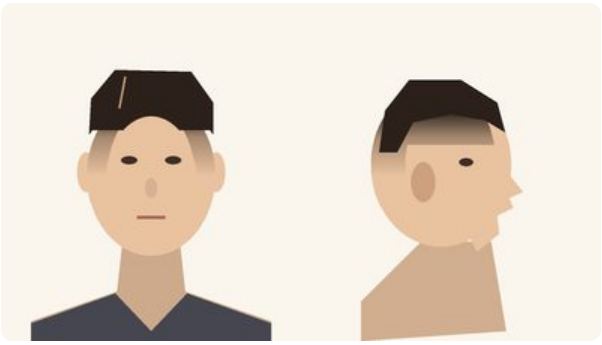
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2; part: razor line, top: scissor 2 in

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A fade with a razored hard part.*

Styling: Pomade and comb.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



100. Lightning Bolt Part

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

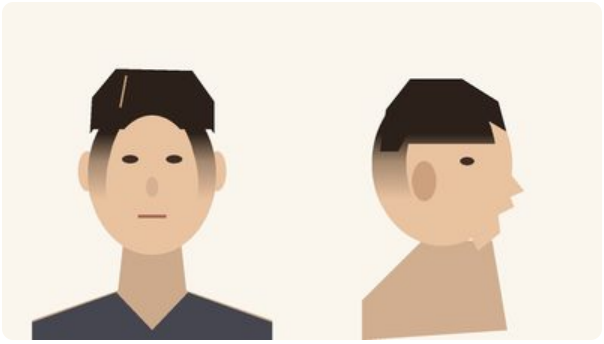
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2; part: lightning bolt design with trimmer

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A fade with a lightning bolt part.*

Styling: Light pomade.

May not suit: Sensitive skin.



101. Straight Line Part Design

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

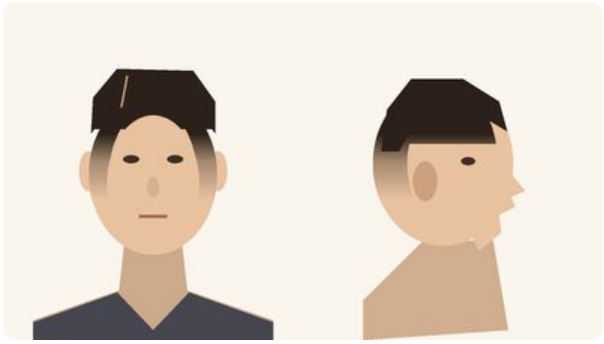
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #1; part: straight design with trimmer

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A short cut with a straight line part design.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



102. Curved Part Design

Intermediate | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

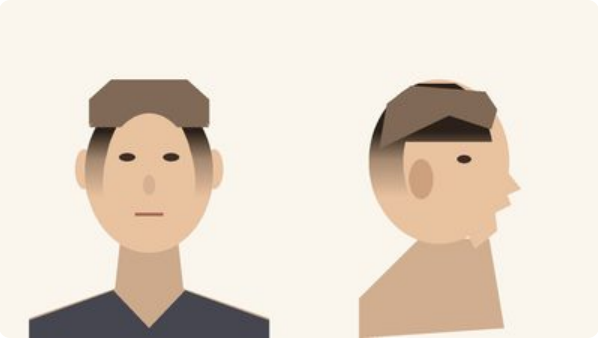
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2; part: curved line with trimmer

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Detail the neckline and edges, brush off loose hair, and check balance from every angle.

Ask for: *A curved part design.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



103. Star Design Buzz

Advanced | Every 1-2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

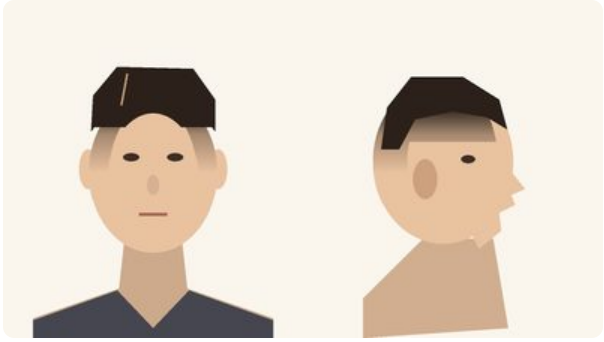
Guards and lengths: Head: #1; design: skin shaved with trimmer

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
5. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A star design on a short buzz.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Needs skill.



104. Double Part Design

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

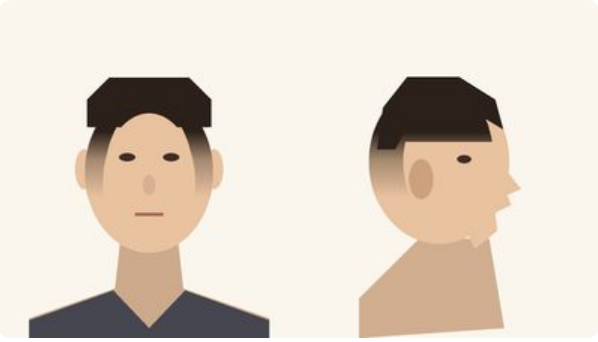
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2; two parts with trimmer

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *Two parts cut into the side.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



105. Fade with Initial Design

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

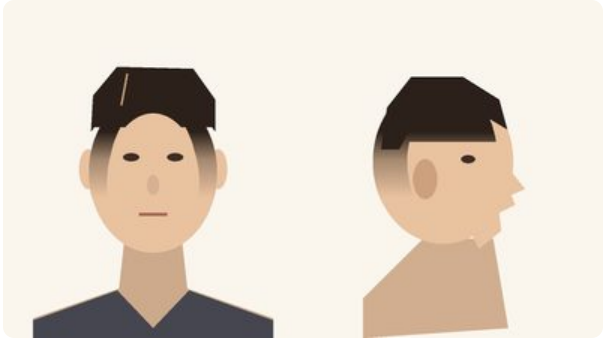
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2; design: initials with trimmer

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
5. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *Faded with an initial design on the side.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Advanced skill.



106. Zigzag Part Fade

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

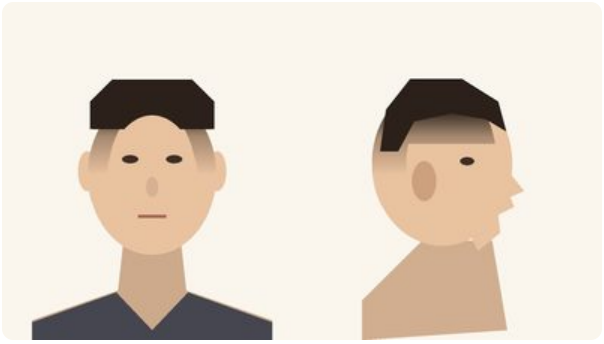
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #1; part: zigzag with trimmer

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the nape and lower sides from skin up to a low fade line about 1 in above the ear.
3. Open the lever and flick upward to blend the low line into the next guard.
4. Find the natural part and mark it with the comb.
5. Cut the top with scissors over comb, leaving more length on the heavy side.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A fade with a zigzag part.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



107. Wave Design Crop

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

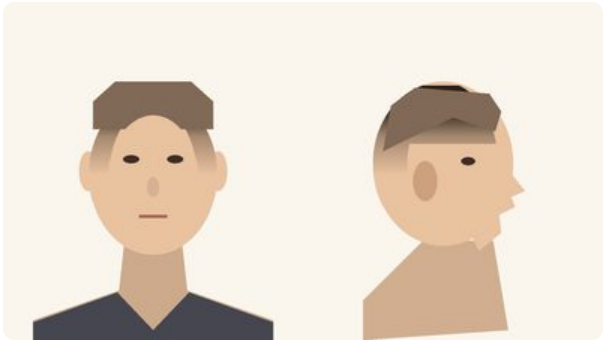
Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2; design: wave lines

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Point-cut the top to build texture, keeping the front short and forward.
5. Cut a blunt fringe line across the front and soften it with the tips of the shears.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A crop with wave line design.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.



108. Geometric Shape Fade

Advanced | Every 2 weeks | straight | wavy | curly | coily | oval | square

Guards and lengths: Sides: skin to #2; design: geometric shapes with trimmer

1. Do a short consultation, sanitize your tools, and drape the client.
2. Cut the lower sides from skin up to a mid fade line about at temple height.
3. Blend the line upward with a lever-open pass and a taller guard until no hard line shows.
4. Clip the top with a single longer guard, working front to back.
5. Cross-check by clipping in a second direction to catch missed hair.
6. Step back, recheck the blend and shape, and refine any weak areas.

Ask for: *A fade with a geometric shape pattern.*

Styling: No product needed; a light scalp moisturizer keeps the skin comfortable.

May not suit: Suits most clients; adjust the length to hair density and growth patterns.

Next step

Pick three styles, practice each on a mannequin, and compare your results with the reference images.